Sometimes, there are fires in the open dump. When waste like Rani's chips packet burns, unhealthy chemicals pollute the ecosystem. These chemicals are present in the air we breathe. The leftover ash from burning waste pollutes the soil.

When it rains, some of the dangerous chemicals goes into the ground. Some of the rain never reaches the ground as it collects in the plastic garbage at the dump. Little pools of water let mosquitoes to breed and they can spread unwanted diseases like dengue and malaria. Cows and dogs go into the open dump looking for food. As the waste is mixed, many things that are not good to eat such as plastics, smell like food. The animals get confused and eat some plastics by accident. This makes them sick.

Rani is a student like you. She does not want to make animals sick. She does not want to pollute beautiful Town. She does not like mosquitoes and wishes that no one ever gets sick from them. So Rani takes this decision "I will dispose the waste property and reduce all type of pollution".

Do you want to do the same as Rani does? Learn about the 3R's and how you can start to solve these problems.

4.5 Solid Waste Management

It is our duty to reduce creating waste and protect environment. 3R's are important in protecting environment. The first R is reduce and the second R is reuse and the last R is recycle.

The waste hierarchy or pyramid shows the best ways to manage solid waste.



3R-Cycle

1. Avoid

Avoid the usage of unwanted materials which create more debris. Before you buy anything, think that "Do I really need it?" (e.g) Avoid buying packed foods. Refuse to buy use and throw plastic products.

2. Reduce

We can reduce the waste by using durable goods that last longer instead of things that are used once and thrown away. (e.g) Write on both sides of papers. Instead of unnecessary printing, use electronic facilities. Share newspapers, magazines and other things with others.

3. Reuse

Reuse means using a thing again and again, rather than using and throwing after a single use. (e.g) Instead of using plastic bags, use and throw pens and batteries, use cloth bags, fountain pens and rechargeable batteries. Reuse glass bottles for other purposes. Repair foot wears and use them.

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